

## ENGLISH LANGUAGE PAPER 4

### PART A Group Interaction

Below is a report from a technology website:

#### How Humans Will Get To Mars In 2023

Guess how they'll get to the planet? Well, a reality television show called *Mars One* plans to pay for the whole project and film the Mars travellers for the rest of their lives. Seriously, that's what the organisers are claiming and they have the support of industry professionals. From the official *Mars One* site:

##### *Mars One's mission objective*

The first crew of four astronauts will establish the first human settlement on Mars by 2023. A new team of four will join the settlement every two years. By 2033 there will be over twenty people living and working on Mars. This will be a one-way trip – the Mars astronauts will wave goodbye to their family and friends forever.

##### *Our vision*

A manned mission to Mars is one of the most exciting, inspiring and ambitious adventures that mankind can have. We see this as a journey that belongs to us all. The entire world will be able to watch and help with decisions as the settlers are selected, follow their extensive training for the mission and of course watch them living on Mars. The mission will provide invaluable scientific and social knowledge that will be accessible to everyone.

Well what do you think.– stupid idea to promote a TV show, or might they really manage it?

Your group wants to give a presentation on humans living on other planets. You may want to talk about:

- the good and bad ideas from the *Mars One* project
- what other issues should be considered when humans live on another planet
- the reasons why people may want to move to another planet
- anything else you think is important

### PART B Individual Response

1. Would you like to live on another planet?
2. What two things would you take to another planet?
3. Are reality TV shows popular in Hong Kong?
4. What types of people should be selected as astronauts?
5. If you were an astronaut on the *Mars One* project, what would the biggest problem be for you?
6. What would you find most exciting if you were an astronaut on the *Mars One* project?
7. Do you think the *Mars One* project will succeed?
8. Do you think space travel should be funded by the government or by private companies?